

INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE LT02

Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Mark scheme

June 2024

Version: 1.0 Final



2 4 6 X L T 0 2 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Assessment Writer.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

1. All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
2. Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
3. Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
4. Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
5. Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
6. Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
7. If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

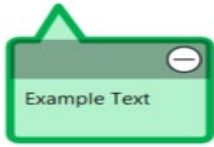
Using the mark bands

8. When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

9. Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
10. There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
11. Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text – text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

12. All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills halfway through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

‘The European attitude towards Africa presented in *Heart of Darkness* denies the humanity of African people.’

How far do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Heart of Darkness* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- colonial exploitation of African people: eg forced labourers at the Central Station, Kurtz’s activities at the Inner Station
- how Kurtz not only exploits Africans, but can be seen to foster barbaric practices
- Marlow’s attitude towards his crew on his expedition to rescue Kurtz: eg fireman is ‘an improved specimen’, helmsman for whom ‘distant kinship is felt’ dies next to him, cannibals are ‘fine fellows’ he ‘could work with’
- perception of humanity in ‘cry, as of infinite desolation’, and ‘unrestrained grief’ as Inner Station is approached
- self-interest of those at the Central Station and the idea that the pitiless treatment of the man supposed to have caused a fire is ‘the only way’, the attitudes of the Eldorado Exploring Expedition and their lack of morality
- Marlow’s perception of the African woman who is the ‘tenebrous and passionate soul’ of Africa.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- use of Marlow as a narrator with a variety of attitudes
- motif of journey into the heart of darkness and its implications
- characterisation of Europeans in contrast to limited characterisation of African people, with little speech attributed to them
- lexical choices, including racist terms, imagery, dialogue
- use of setting, particularly Africa as seen from Congo river, to convey limitation of European perspective
- narrative framed by European settings with link at end between the ‘tragic’ figure of the African woman and Kurtz’s fiancée.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the text as a whole.

0 2

F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

‘American society is presented as offering limitless opportunities, but human ambition is shown to end in disillusion and failure.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Great Gatsby* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Gatsby as a rags-to-riches character offered limitless opportunities by prohibition
- Gatsby’s failure to win Daisy, but deluded even at his death as he believes she will call him
- self-indulgence as seen in parties and consumerism
- lack of opportunities in valley of ashes, which can be seen as a place of tragic failure
- return of Nick Carraway to Mid-West shows the end of his commercial ambition, but he returns with clearer understanding of society
- disillusion of failed marriage for Wilson, Myrtle dies without escaping the valley of ashes
- how Buchanan’s wealth places Tom and Daisy outside the need to strive for more material success and beyond disillusion and failure.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- the narrative structure of Gatsby’s tragedy as it moves through ambition and its fulfilment in material terms to near fulfilment in love only to end with loss
- Nick Carraway as a homodiegetic narrator who is part of the society, but also able to make judgements on it
- symbolism: eg dust (valley of ashes, Gatsby’s house at the end) green (green light, ‘green breast of the new world’), blood (Myrtle’s and Gatsby’s), cars, houses, T J Eckleburg
- the relationship between settings: eg contrast between valley of ashes and East and West Egg, the separation of East and West Egg, New York lying beyond valley of ashes
- lexical choices, metaphor, dialogue and argument with key expressions: eg ‘Mr Nobody from Nowhere’, ‘Why of course you can’
- use of back stories of Dan Cody and Gatsby with Daisy before the war.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the whole novel.

0 3

Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

‘In *Remains of the Day*, Ishiguro presents us with a society that is disconnected from the wider world.’

How far do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Remains of the Day* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Darlington Hall as a country house of high society dominated by master-servant relationships
- how the various places Stevens visits on his journey to the West Country are parts of the wider world, but perhaps only serve to show his world as disconnected
- how the wider world impinges on Darlington Hall through its visitors: eg John Maynard Keynes, H G Wells and Ribbentrop
- Lord Darlington’s concern to avoid another war with Germany
- love story, a universal topic, central to the narrative
- how the present day of the novel is a time of change at Darlington Hall under its new American owner.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- how Stevens’ journey into the West Country facilitates the introduction of characters from outside Darlington Hall and different attitudes and values
- how Stevens’ narrative perspective is both narrow and unreliable
- the use of the unofficial international conference to present aspects of the wider world
- the use of characters such as Dupont and Lewis to bring in international relations
- how the speeches of Lord Darlington and Lewis in the banqueting hall present conflicting political views of the wider world
- how details of the domestic concerns of Stevens and Miss Kenton, and their differences, present the enclosed world of the country house
- different perspectives from that of Stevens presented through dialogue in both Darlington Hall and during his journey.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the whole novel.

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

Consider the narrative significance of the destruction of neighbourliness in Vishram Society.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Last Man in Tower* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the gradual estrangement of the residents of Tower A, known as ‘Vishram Society’
- the close proximity of the residents in their apartments and how at the beginning they are a largely harmonious society of different characters
- Vishram Society as a co-operative housing society that has a democratic plastic-chair parliament
- how monetary gain is the key factor in the destruction of Vishram society
- Dharmen Shah as a predatory property speculator who sees the community as an obstruction to be overcome
- residents who feel they belong to the place: eg Pintos who only give in after intimidation, Masterji who resists to the last, others who are gradually persuaded
- the wider context of Mumbai as a developing, modernising city.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- the contrast provided by Tower B with its young executives, who quickly sell out
- the use of dialogue to present conflict and division
- a narrative that unfolds chronologically to convey increasing pressure on residents to leave Vishram Society
- use of precise dates and deadlines as part of rising tension and movement towards the destruction of the Society
- the title and how it presents the culmination of the destruction of the Society, with the murder of Masterji as the climax of the narrative
- presentation of plastic-chair parliament and its decline: eg it becomes a form of conspiracy to overcome Masterji’s resistance to leaving
- language features: eg lexical choices and imagery as features of description that reflect differing concerns and attitudes of residents, and of Shah.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the whole novel.

0 5

Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

Consider the significance of Adichie's use of the three different national settings in her presentation of attitudes to race.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Americanah* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Nigeria as a place of political conflict and corruption early on that is initially a place to leave, but is returned to as a homeland and becomes a place of opportunity for Obinze as the country develops economically
- Nigerian culture and how far characters identify themselves with it or distance themselves from it
- the opportunities that America is seen to offer and the desire among young Nigerians to become an Americanah
- the reality of America as experienced by Ifemelu and Auntie Uju: eg racism, exploitation, having to adapt, success, love affairs, marriage
- Obinze being in England for three years, separating him from Ifemelu: eg the physical and emotional distance between them (even when she visits for the Glastonbury festival)
- the actions and experiences of illegal immigrants in the more conservative and restrictive society of England, the contrast between Ifemelu and Obinze.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- third-person narration with Ifemelu as principal focaliser in Nigeria and America, but with different perspectives through other characters: eg Obinze, Ranyinudo, Uju
- contrasts between Nigeria, America and England through narratives with different outcomes: eg Ifemelu chooses to return but Obinze is deported
- contrasts between Nigeria, America and England in terms of settings used to portray different societies with Nigeria as a place of change
- dialogue at the party in Islington hosted by Emenike and Georgina in which attitudes towards immigration in America and Europe are compared
- blogs that convey responses to and comments on American society
- hair as a motif and its function in relation to racism
- language features: eg imagery, lexical choices, descriptive detail.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the whole novel.

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

‘In *Small Island*, English ignorance and mistrust are presented as being more significant than Jamaican naivety in interracial relationships.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Small Island* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- English racial prejudice as seen in the unwillingness of many characters to accept interracial relationships and how Queenie has to give up her child
- Queenie soon trusts Gilbert when she first meets him, accepts him and Hortense as lodgers
- Hortense’s fantasy of an English home can be seen as naivety which is also evident when she encounters ignorance and mistrust: eg while shopping with Queenie
- acceptance of child by Hortense and Gilbert shows willingness to adapt, rather than naivety
- intimate relationship between Queenie and Michael can be seen to challenge given view but may be seen as naivety on her part
- Hortense’s visit to the education office, where English mistrust can be seen to be more significant despite Hortense’s naivety
- how Gilbert’s more realistic attitude highlights English ignorance and mistrust.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- English ignorance introduced in the Prologue through the visit to Africa at the Empire Exhibition
- narrative structure: eg the developing pattern of Hortense and Gilbert becoming accustomed to living in England contrasted with persistent English ignorance and mistrust
- Hortense’s idiolect as a sign of her naivety
- conflict between characters presented through dialogue and action revealing differing attitudes
- racist language used by English characters
- conflicting attitudes presented through perspectives of different narrators
- differences in dialect and other aspects of language use such as lexical choices and figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the whole novel.

0 7

Thomas Hardy poetry selection

‘Hardy’s poetry is dominated by feelings of isolation.’

How far do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Hardy’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Hardy’s remote settings: eg Beeny Cliff, Castle Boterel and the cliff top of ‘After a Journey’
- the grieving speaker: eg ‘The Going’, ‘Places’
- relationships in memories of family and concerns for others or society: eg ‘The Self Unseeing’, ‘To An Unborn Pauper Child’, ‘Channel Firing’
- failed relationships: eg ‘At an Inn’, ‘Neutral Tones’, but continuing relationship despite loss in ‘The Going’, ‘After a Journey’, ‘At Castle Boterel’
- wider social issues such as war and human folly
- individual sadness and loss of hope
- the sense of belonging and possible hope in ‘The Oxen’.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of poetic method:

- use of first person and direct address to lost lover
- narrative pattern that culminates in a feeling of isolation or connection: eg ‘The Darkling Thrush’, ‘To an Unborn Pauper Child’
- structural use of stanza form and rhyme
- features of description that present an isolated setting: eg seascape, perspective from cliff, fading memories in Castle Boterel, familiar place but isolation in loss: eg ‘The Going’
- figurative language, lexical choices
- mood and how it is conveyed: eg resignation in ‘The Darkling Thrush’, but some consolation in ‘After a Journey’.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of poetic method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the whole collection.

0 8

William Wordsworth poetry selection

‘Wordsworth finds magnificence in simple things.’

How far do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘Composed upon Westminster Bridge’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Wordsworth’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the everyday setting of ‘Westminster Bridge’, but view seen as majestic
- how the ‘simple’ life of Michael and his family can be viewed as either magnificent or commonplace, or both to some degree
- how the sightseeing of ‘Tintern Abbey’ leads to heightened spiritual insights and the exposition of a philosophy of life
- ‘Daffodils’ merely as a simple, joyous response to ordinary flowers or as the discovery of ‘magnificence in simple things’
- the environmental implications of ‘Nutting’ arising out of a boy’s experience
- how an everyday walk in ‘A Narrow Girdle of Stones and Crags’ gives rise to a moral concept
- how a simple wish to preserve future pleasure in ‘Yarrow Unvisited’ leads to more complex thoughts and feelings.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure of ‘Composed upon Westminster Bridge’ in which the opening statement of lines 1–3 is followed by an accumulation of descriptive details with heightened lexical choices and repetition of ‘never’ to convey surpassing beauty
- structure in ‘Tintern Abbey’ – the initial description of the scene leads to contemplation and reflection, but the poem ends by focusing again on immediate surroundings
- the narrative structure of ‘Michael’ in which a retrospective story is framed by the stones of the unfinished sheepfold
- the sequence in ‘Nutting’: eg from ‘boyish hope’ through destructive action to conflicting feelings over despoiling and then a final message
- the use of first person to present emotional experiences in response to simple things
- figurative language, lexical choices
- regular and irregular stanza forms, sonnet form, rhyme and metre.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the poems should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of poetic method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the whole collection.

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Robert Frost poetry selection

‘What at first sight seem to be ordinary encounters with the natural world ultimately reveal the depth and variety of human experience.’

How far you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Frost’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how being faced with a simple choice between two paths might lead to inner reflection and philosophic thought
- everyday work activities in ‘After Apple Picking’ or ‘Mending Wall’ perhaps giving rise to thoughts around mortality or neighbourliness
- the effect of an occurrence in the night sky in ‘An Unstamped Letter in Our Rural Letter Box’ in which the writer reflects on the differing experiences of him and his reader
- the social, historical and religious thoughts stimulated by the isolated black cottage
- readings that emphasise accessibility
- the encounter with the snowy landscape of ‘Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening’ or of ‘Desert Places’ being the speaker’s encounter with himself.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of poetic method:

- narrative structure based around a key event such as arriving at the junction of the ‘two roads’ or swinging on birch trees followed by the development of thoughts and reflections and arriving at a distinct conclusion
- the first-person voice and its use to establish a close relationship with the reader
- the structural use of details as an experience unfolds: eg walking through snow, then the small bird with its imagined thoughts leading to finding the wood-pile and the reflections to which it gives rise
- versification: eg stanza form, rhyme and structural use of rhyme
- lexical choices, figurative language and use of speech rhythms to convey ‘ordinary encounters’
- tone as it can be found in the speaker’s attitude towards his audience and his topic.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of poetic method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the whole collection.

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Seamus Heaney poetry selection

‘Heaney presents the relationships between people and places as always being uneasy.’

How far do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘The Toome Road’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Heaney’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the speaker’s response in ‘The Toome Road’ to the presence of British soldiers in a place that belongs to him and his neighbours
- how observing the long dead, as in ‘The Grauballe Man’ and ‘Punishment’, brings to mind a variety of thoughts about the Ireland of the speaker’s present
- the relationships being more than uneasy: eg ‘The Tollund Man’, ‘Requiem for the Croppies’, ‘Punishment’
- the political landscape impinging on a personal relationship in ‘Act of Union’
- the untroubled relationship with places in such poems as ‘Anahorish’, ‘A New Song’, ‘Westering’ and ‘Peninsula’
- the positive nature of unease in ‘Personal Helicon’.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the narrative structure of ‘The Toome Road’ with a sequence of encounter, question, features of place, question and final assertion of the relationship between the speaker and his spiritual home
- unease or stronger response presented through narrative voices: eg a voice of history in ‘North’, a croppy speaks from his grave, the first-person observer in ‘Punishment’
- structural development through the accumulation of detail with personal responses interwoven and/or placed as conclusion: eg ‘The Tollund Man’, ‘Punishment’, ‘The Grauballe Man’, ‘Peninsula’, ‘Bog Queen’
- imagery of unease and/or violence, but also contentment and/or happiness
- mood as in the speaker’s attitude towards the subject: eg ‘Personal Helicon’, ‘North’, ‘Anahorish’, or/and tone as in the speaker’s attitude towards the reader: eg ‘Bog Queen’, ‘Peninsula’
- lexical choices for past events that resonate with contemporary significance, figurative language
- versification: eg double sonnet form of ‘Act of Union’, the use of quatrains and other stanza forms, metre, rhyme and half-rhyme.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of poetic method, any valid interpretations and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the whole collection.